

Ἑλληνικὰ Ἀνώνυμα

Greek Affairs as Recorded by the Hellenica Anonymous

eul_aid: ecy

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)

Dialect: [Ἀττική](#) [Attic](#)

Domain: [Ἱστορία](#) [History](#)

Format: [Πεζός](#) [Prose](#)

Hellenica Anonymous

Life

No biographical details of the anonymous author survive. Conventionally termed the "Oxyrhynchus Historian" after the Egyptian site where the principal papyrus fragments were found, he was a contemporary of the events he describes. His narrative covers Greek history from 411 to at least 395 BCE, continuing from where Thucydides' history ends. His detailed knowledge of Peloponnesian affairs, especially regarding the Spartan commander Lysander, suggests he may have been from the Peloponnese, possibly Sparta.

Works

The author is known solely for a fragmentary historical work, the Hellenica, preserved on papyri. It is often cited as the Hellenica Oxyrhynchia.

Significance

The Hellenica Oxyrhynchia is a major primary source for a poorly documented period, offering a detailed contemporary account of the Peloponnesian War's end and its aftermath. Its discovery provided a critical alternative to Xenophon's Hellenica, with a more detailed and sometimes divergent narrative, particularly on Aegean events and Spartan naval operations. The historian's critical method, attempt at impartiality, and focus on causation mark him as an important figure in Greek historiography between Thucydides and later writers.

Works (5)

- [Φλωρεντινὰ Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [Florentine Fragments](#) · 13 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ τῆς Ἐφεσιακῆς Στρατείας](#) · [Fragments on Ephesian Campaign](#) · 2 passages
- [Ἱστορικά Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἑλληνικῶν Πραγμάτων](#) · [Historical Fragments on Greek Affairs](#) · 11 passages
- [Λονδινὰ Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [London Fragments](#) · 60 passages
- [Λονδινὰ Ἀποσπάσματα Ἀδήλου Θέσεως](#) · [London Fragments of Uncertain Placement](#) · 1 passages